Central Government and the revenue shared with States under IGST Act 2017.

e. IGST on exports - All exports are treated as Inter-State supply under GST. Since exports are zero rated, GST is not imposed on all goods and services exported from India. Any input credit paid already on exports will be refunded.

## 33.03 GST Council

The GST Council will oversee the implementation of the GST. But the Central Board of Excise and Customs is responsible for administration of the CGST and IGST Acts. The Council makes recommendations on rate of GST, apportionment of IGST, exemptions, model GST laws, etc.

The Chairman of the Council is the Union Finance Minister. The Minister of State in the Finance Ministry and all Finance Ministers of the State Governments shall be its members. The Central Government shall have 1/3rd voting power and all State Governments shall have 2/3rd voting powers. All decisions of the Council can be passed only with ¾th of the total votes. Each state has one vote, irrespective of its size or population. Twenty four council meetings were held until 2017.

### Apart from the GST Council, GST Secretariat was formed with the following officials

i. The Secretary (Revenue) will be appointed as the Ex-officio Secretary to the GST Council.

ii. The Chairperson, Central Board of Excise and Customs (CBEC), will be a permanent invitee (non-voting).

iii. One post of Additional Secretary to the GST, and

iv Four posts of Commissioner in the GST Council Secretariat will also be created.

### Objectives of GST

1. The foremost objective of GST is to create a common market with uniform tax rate in India. (One Nation, One Tax, One Market)
2. To eliminate the cascading effect of taxes, GST allows set-off of prior taxes for the same transactions as input tax credit.
3. To boost Indian exports, the GST already collected on the inputs will be refunded and thus there will be no tax on all exports.
4. To increase the tax base by bringing more number of tax payers and increase tax revenue.
5. To simplify tax return procedures through common forms and avoidance of visiting tax departments.
6. To provide online facilities for payment of taxes and submission of forms. Goods and Services Network (GSTN), a robust Information Technology system has been created for the operation of GST.

### Benefits of GST

#### A. To the Society and country

1. Unified common national market will attract more foreign investment. GST has integrated the economy of all States and Union Territories.
2. It brings parity in taxation among imported goods and Indian manufactured goods. All imported goods



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